STATE ELECTION COMMISSION
N.C.T. OF DELHI & UT CHANDIGARH
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PRESS NOTE

Subject: General Elections to 272 wards of the three Municipal Corporations of Delhi viz. North Delhi, South Delhi & East Delhi, scheduled to be held in April, 2017.

The terms of the three Municipal Corporations (North Delhi, South Delhi & East Delhi MCs) are going to expire in April, 2017. The Commission will hold General Elections to the three Municipal Corporations (North Delhi, South Delhi & East Delhi) on 22nd April, 2017

Hours of Poll: 8.00 AM to 5.30 PM (without break)

The delimitation of all the Wards of three Municipal Corporations was undertaken by the Commission on the basis of 2011 Census. The Delimitation Order of 272 Wards of all the three Municipal Corporations has been notified vide Delhi Government Notification dated 13.01.2017(available on SEC website www.sec.delhigovt.nic.in). The total number of Wards in all the three Corporations remain same as 272 whereas the boundaries of these Wards have been redrawn within the limits of respective Assembly Constituencies. Also, the Wards have been renamed and renumbered.

(1) Municipal Wards

The total number of Municipal Wards in the three Municipal Corporations (North Delhi, South Delhi & East Delhi) of Delhi and seats reserved for the, Scheduled Castes, SC Women and Women have already been notified vide reservation order No. F.4(211)/OSD.I/Legal/SEC/2017/5838 dated 06.02.2017 as follows: -

Name of Municipal Corporation	Total No. of Wards	No. of seats for General Candidates	No. of seats reserved for Woman (SC)	No. of seats reserved for SCs	No. of seats reserved for Woman
North	104	42	10	10	42
South	104	44	8	7	45
East	64	26	6	5	27

(2) Electoral Rolls

The electoral rolls of all the assembly constituency of Delhi covering all the Wards in the three Municipal Corporations (North, South & East MCs) of Delhi have been updated with reference to 01.01.2017 as the qualifying date and published in final on 10.01.2017 by the Chief Electoral Officer Delhi. These electoral rolls have been adopted by the Commission under the relevant provisions of election law for use in the forth-coming General Elections to the three MCs.

(a) Photo Electoral Rolls

Photo Electoral Rolls will be used during the above General Elections.

(b) Electors Photo Identity Cards (EPIC)

Identification of the voters at the polling booth at the time of poll shall be mandatory. Electors who have been provided with EPIC shall be identified through EPIC.

All the residual electors are advised to obtain their Elector Photo Identity Cards from the Electoral Registration Officers of their respective Assembly Constituencies, urgently.

In order to ensure that no voter is deprived of his/her franchise, if his/her name figures in the Electoral Rolls. Separate instructions will be issued to allow additional documents for identification of voters, if needed.

(c) Photo Voter Slips

To facilitate the voters to know where he/she is enrolled as a voter at a particular polling station and what is his/her serial number in the Electoral roll, the Commission has directed that official **voter slip bearing the Photo of the elector (wherever present in the roll) will be distributed** to all the enrolled voters by the concerned District Election Officer/ Returning Officers.

(3) **Polling Stations:** The number of Polling Stations in the Wards covered in the three Municipal Corporations (North Delhi, South Delhi & East Delhi) of Delhi are as follows:-

Municipal Corporations	No. of Polling Stations in 2012	No. of Polling Stations in 2017(approximate)
North	4482	5170
South	4388	5074
East	2672	2990

(a) **Assured Minimum Facilities (AMF) at Polling Stations.**

The Commission has upgraded the status of facilities at the Polling Stations from the earlier concept of Basic Minimum Facilities (BMF) to Assured Minimum Facilities (AMF). Accordingly, instructions have been issued to the Commissioners of all three Municipal Corporations and other concerned agencies to ensure that **every Polling Station is equipped with Assured Minimum Facilities** (AMF) like drinking water, shed, toilet, ramp for the physically challenged voters, a standard voting compartment etc. for the convenience and facilitation of voters.

(b) **Special Arrangement For Disabled Voters:**

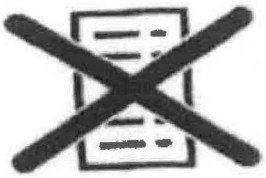
The Commission has issued instructions to ensure that as far as practicable, all polling stations are located at ground floor and sturdy ramps are provided for the convenience of disabled electors.

(4) **Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs):**

The poll in the three Municipal Corporations (North, South & East MCDs) of Delhi will be conducted at all polling stations using EVMs. The Commission has already made arrangements to ensure availability of adequate number of EVMs for the smooth conduct of elections.

(a) **Mock Poll:** As per the Commission's instructions, a Mock Poll shall be conducted by the Presiding Officer at each Polling Station before the commencement of actual polling in the presence of the Polling Agents set up by the contesting candidates and a **Certificate** of successful conduct of the Mock Poll shall be made by the Presiding Officer.

(b) **None Of The Above (NOTA) In EVMs:** On the Balloting Unit, **below the name of the last candidate**, there will now be a button for NOTA option so that electors who do not want to vote for any of the candidates can exercise their option by pressing the button against NOTA. The **Commission has provided a new symbol for the NOTA option**, which was designed by National Institute of Design (NID). This new symbol will facilitate the voters in casting of their votes.



NOTA Symbol

(c) Photographs Of Candidates On EVM Ballot Paper

In order to facilitate the electors in identifying the candidates, the Commission has prescribed an additional measure by way of adding provision for printing the photograph of candidate also on the ballot paper to be displayed on the EVM (Ballot Unit). This will also take care to avoid likely confusion when candidates with same or similar names contest from the same Wards.

(5). **Deployment of Election Personnel**

The Commission has engaged Officers/ Officials from Central Government, Delhi Government, MCs and other Government Departments/ Agencies/ Autonomous Bodies/ Government Undertakings for conduct of Election, 2017. The details of Officers/ Officials deployed in the elections are as under:

1	District Election Officer (DEOs)	11		5	Sector Officers	1500 (Approx.)
2	General Observers	72		6	Expenditure Observers	72
3	Returning Officers (ROs)	72		7	Polling Staff	70,000 (Approx.)
4	Assistant Returning Officers (AROs)	272				

(6) **Videography Coverage**

All critical events will be video-graphed by the Commission and it will arrange sufficient number of video and digital cameras and camera teams for the purpose. The events for videography will include filing of nomination papers and scrutiny thereof, allotment of symbols, First Level Checking, preparations and storage of Electronic Voting Machines, important public meetings, processions etc. during election campaign.

(7) **Law and Order, Security Arrangements And Deployment Of Forces**

The conduct of elections involves elaborate security management by Delhi Police Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) are also deployed to supplement the local

police force in ensuring a peaceful and conducive atmosphere for the smooth conduct of elections in a free, fair and credible manner, if required.

(8) Effective use of Media:

Multimedia campaign:-

The Commission has decided to enhance its interaction and involvement with all the stakeholders in the electoral processes by inducting the use of social media. To enhance the voting percentage in the ensuing elections, the Commission will use print/ radio/ electronic and social media.

(9) Deployment of Observers:

a. General Observers

The Commission will deploy General Observers in adequate number to observe all election activities and to ensure smooth conduct of elections. The Observers will be asked to keep a close watch on every stage of the electoral process to ensure free and fair elections. Their names, addresses within the ward(s) and their telephone numbers will be publicised in local newspapers so that the general public can easily approach them for any grievance redressal. The Observers will be given a detailed briefing by the Commission before their deployment. The Observers will fix a suitable time every day for meeting the political parties, candidates and other stakeholders to redress their election related grievances.

b. Expenditure Observers.

The Commission has also decided to appoint adequate number of Expenditure Observers who will exclusively monitor the election expenditure of the contesting candidates.

(10) Model Code of Conduct

Model code of conduct shall be in force from w.e.f. 14th March, 2017 in all the 272 wards and shall continue to be in force till declaration of result of election. The government, the ruling party including the local bodies shall not announce any financial grant in any form or promises thereof. No foundation stone of any project or scheme of any kind shall be laid in these wards during the said period. No promises for works like construction of roads, new drinking water facilities, construction of playgrounds or launching new schemes or projects etc. will be made during the aforesaid period so as to attract/ influence the voters. However, the scheme/project of the government/local bodies etc.

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b. Expenditure Observers.

The Commission has also decided to appoint adequate number of Expenditure Observers who will exclusively monitor the election expenditure of the contesting candidates.

(10) Model Code of Conduct

Model code of conduct shall be in force from w.e.f. 15th March, 2017 in all the 272 wards and shall continue to be in force till declaration of result of election. The government, the ruling party including the local bodies shall not announce any financial grant in any form or promises thereof. No foundation stone of any project or scheme of any kind shall be laid in these wards during the said period. No promises for works like construction of roads, new drinking water facilities, construction of playgrounds or launching new schemes or projects etc. will be made during the aforesaid period so as to attract/ influence the voters. However, the scheme/project of the government/local bodies etc. already in progress may continue. Political Parties and contesting candidates are

requested to also strictly abide by the provisions of **The Delhi Prevention of Defacement of Property Act, 2007.** Any violation of the said Act will be viewed seriously and penal/ remedial actions will be taken promptly.

The Model Code of Conduct **comes into effect immediately** from now onwards. All the provisions of the Model Code will apply in all the 272 Wards in the three Municipal Corporations (North, South & East MCs) of Delhi and will be applicable to all candidates, political parties, the Govt. of NCT of Delhi and the Municipal Corporations. The Commission has printed sufficient numbers of booklets on MCC in English and Hindi languages and these booklets will be issued to all the Political Parties and the Contesting Candidates shortly.

Measures to Prevent Public Nuisance:

(a) Restrictions on the use of loudspeakers:

The Commission is genuinely concerned about the serious 'noise pollution' and great disturbance to the peace and tranquility of the general public by the reckless, widespread and flagrant use of loudspeakers during election canvassing and campaign by candidates, political parties and their agents. To prevent such nuisance, the Commission has directed that the use of public address system or loudspeakers or any sound amplifier, whether fitted on vehicles of any kind whatsoever, or in static position used for public meetings for electioneering purposes, during the entire election period starting from the date of announcement of election and ending with the date of declaration of results, shall not be permitted **at night between 10.00 p.m. and 6.00 a.m."**

Further, No loudspeakers fitted on vehicles of any kind or in any other manner whatsoever shall be permitted to be used during the period of 48 hours ending with the hour fixed for the conclusion of the poll in any polling area.

(11) Affidavits Of candidates:

All the candidates at the time of filling nomination papers with the concerned Returning Officers are required to file two Affidavits in the prescribed forms viz. Form 21 & Form 22 (available with the Returning Officers regarding their criminal background, if any, assets & liabilities and educational qualifications, etc.)

All Columns to be filled In: In pursuance of the judgment dated 13th September, 2013 passed by the Supreme Court in Writ Petition (C) No.

September, 2013 passed by the Supreme Court in Writ Petition (C) No. 121 of 2008 (Resurgence India Vs Election Commission of India and Another), which among other things makes it obligatory for the Returning Officer "to check whether the information required is fully furnished (by the candidate) at the time of filing of affidavit with the nomination paper", the Commission has issued instructions that in the affidavit to be filed along-with the nomination paper, candidates are required to fill up all columns. If any column in the affidavit is left blank, the Returning Officer will issue a notice to the candidate to file the revised affidavit with all columns duly filled in before the hour of scrutiny of nomination. After such notice, if a candidate still fails to file affidavit completed in all respects, the nomination paper will be liable to be rejected by the Returning Officer at the time of scrutiny.

(12) General guidelines for Candidates

(a) The candidates can file nominations in the offices of the respective Returning Officers (already appointed by the Commission), whose names, designations and official addresses were published in leading news paper dated 16.02.2017 and also available on this Commissions' website www.sec.delhigovt.nic.in.

(b) In case a candidate of a National Party or of a Delhi State Party as recognized by the Election Commission of India desires to contest the above said election, he/she will be required to file his/ her nomination paper duly proposed by an elector from the same ward. Candidates of State Parties (not recognized for NCT of Delhi, but are recognized in other States) and other candidates including the Independent candidates will have to file nomination papers with 10 proposers being voters of the same Ward from where the candidate is being proposed. **A security of Rs.5000/- (Rupees five thousand only) for each candidate shall have to be deposited in cash with the Returning Officer at the time of filing of nomination paper and when the candidate is a member of a Scheduled Caste, this amount shall be 50% less i.e. Rs.2500/- (Rupees two thousand five hundred only).**

(d) The maximum limit of election expenditure which a candidate can incur in connection with an election to a Ward of a Municipal Corporation, Delhi is **Rs.5,75,000/- (Rupees five lacs seventy five thousand only).** Every nominated candidate shall be required to maintain account of his/her election expenses from the date he/she is nominated till he/she has withdrawn or his/her nomination has been rejected/declaration of result of the election, as the case may be, in the prescribed form and manner and submit the same to the concerned Returning Officer within ten (10) days of the declaration of the result of the election. A register for the maintenance

instructions on the subject and a Performa of Affidavit to be filed by the candidates along with the register of accounts will be supplied to each candidate by the RO concerned at the time of filling nomination papers.

The Commission now seeks the active cooperation, close collaboration and constructive partnership of all the esteemed stakeholders in the electoral process and strives to employ the collective synergies towards delivering smooth, free, fair, participative and festive elections.

(GIRISH PANDEY)
DY. SECRETARY